Unit 1 Section 3 – Marketing Mix

Quick-Fire & IAL-Style Teacher Pack

Section 1: Product (Product Life Cycle & Boston Matrix)

- Quick Questions
    - • Define the product life cycle [2].
    - • List the stages of the product life cycle [2].
    - • Explain one reason why a business may use extension strategies [4].
    - • Define the Boston Matrix [2].
    - • Identify and explain the four categories of the Boston Matrix [4].
    - • Explain how the product life cycle links to the Boston Matrix [4].
    - • What is meant by product portfolio analysis [4]?
    - • Why might a business discontinue a product in the decline stage [4]?
    - • Explain one benefit of having a balanced product portfolio [6].
    - • Explain how the introduction stage affects cash flow [4].
- IAL-Style Exam Tasks
    - • Define the term product portfolio [2].
    - • Explain one benefit of using the Boston Matrix [4].
    - • Assess the usefulness of the product life cycle model for a new product launch [6].
    - • Discuss how extension strategies can help a business maintain market share [8].
    - • Evaluate the importance of product portfolio management to long-term success [10].
- Plenary Question
    - • Which is more useful for strategic decision-making – the product life cycle or the Boston Matrix? Justify.

Section 2: Product Design & Social Trends (Slides – Design Mix 2025)

- Quick Questions
    - • Define the design mix [2].
    - • Identify the three elements of the design mix [2].
    - • Explain one reason why aesthetics are important for consumer products [4].
    - • Explain how function contributes to customer satisfaction [4].
    - • How does cost influence design decisions [4]?
    - • What is meant by adapting the design mix to reflect social trends [4]?
    - • Give one example of how sustainability can affect product design [4].
    - • Explain the term ‘ethical sourcing’ [4].
    - • Why might businesses redesign packaging to reduce waste [4]?
    - • Explain one benefit to a business of adapting products for social trends [4].

- IAL-Style Exam Tasks
    - • Define the term design mix [2].
    - • Explain one way that social trends can influence product design [4].
    - • Assess the importance of sustainability in the design mix [6].
    - • Discuss whether aesthetics are more important than cost in product design [8].
    - • Evaluate the extent to which adapting the design mix improves brand reputation [10].
- Plenary Question
    - • Is adapting the design mix to meet social trends always beneficial for businesses? Justify.

Section 3: Price (Slides – Pricing Strategies 2025)

- Quick Questions
    - • Define pricing strategy [2].
    - • List two examples of pricing strategies [2].
    - • Explain what is meant by penetration pricing [4].
    - • Explain what is meant by skimming pricing [4].
    - • Explain one benefit of competitive pricing [4].
    - • Explain the difference between cost-plus and value-based pricing [4].
    - • What is meant by psychological pricing [2]?
    - • Explain one risk of using a discount pricing strategy [4].
    - • Why might elasticity of demand influence pricing decisions [4]?
    - • Explain how pricing strategy can affect brand image [4].
- IAL-Style Exam Tasks
    - • Define the term penetration pricing [2].
    - • Explain one advantage of price skimming for a new product [4].
    - • Assess the impact of competitive pricing on market share [6].
    - • Discuss the usefulness of psychological pricing in consumer markets [8].
    - • Evaluate whether cost-plus pricing is appropriate in highly competitive industries [10].
- Plenary Question
    - • Which pricing strategy do you think is most effective for a new business and why?

Section 4: Promotion & Branding (Slides – Promotion & Branding 2025)

- Quick Questions
    - • Define promotion [2].
    - • List two elements of the promotional mix [2].
    - • Define branding [2].
    - • Explain one benefit of strong branding [4].

- • Explain how promotion supports brand loyalty [4].
- • What is meant by emotional branding [4]?
- • Explain one disadvantage of heavy promotional spending [4].
- • What is meant by public relations (PR) [2]?
- • Explain one benefit of sponsorship as a promotional tool [4].
- • Why is digital promotion increasingly important [4]?

- IAL-Style Exam Tasks
  - • Define the term branding [2].
  - • Explain one benefit of using digital promotion [4].
  - • Assess how effective branding can add value to a business [6].
  - • Discuss whether spending more on promotion always leads to higher sales [8].
  - • Evaluate whether branding is the most important element of the marketing mix [10].

- Plenary Question
  - • Is promotion or branding more important for long-term business success? Justify.

Section 5: Place (Slides – Distribution 2025)

- Quick Questions
  - • Define distribution channel [2].
  - • List two types of distribution channel [2].
  - • Explain one benefit of direct distribution [4].
  - • Explain one benefit of using wholesalers [4].
  - • What is meant by multichannel distribution [4]?
  - • Explain one disadvantage of using intermediaries [4].
  - • How does online distribution benefit consumers [4]?
  - • Explain why physical stores remain important for some products [4].
  - • What is meant by supply chain management [4]?
  - • Explain one way businesses ensure efficient distribution [4].

- IAL-Style Exam Tasks
  - • Define the term distribution channel [2].
  - • Explain one benefit of multichannel distribution [4].
  - • Assess the advantages and disadvantages of online distribution [6].
  - • Discuss how effective distribution channels can increase competitiveness [8].
  - • Evaluate the extent to which online distribution benefits both consumers and firms [10].

- Plenary Question
  - • Which distribution method is most effective for ensuring customer satisfaction? Justify.